balancing agility with assurance and keeping alignment between business goals and system behavior.

14.2 The policy management lifecycle

Governance provides structure to authorization, but the policy management lifecycle gives it rhythm. Policies, like identities, move through predictable stages, each guided by a mix of organizational oversight and technical control. Figure 14.2 shows the policy lifecycle ACME uses to keep its authorization environment both flexible and reliable.

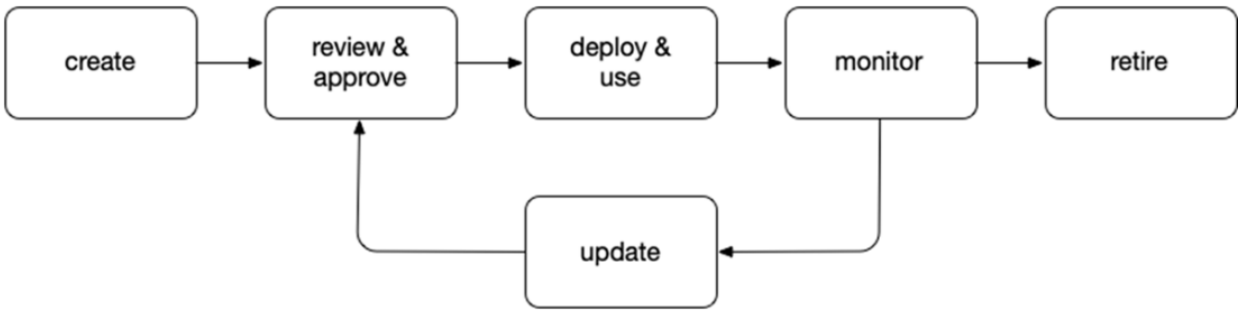


Figure 14.2 The policy management lifecycle. Policies go through distinct stages—creation, review and approval, deployment and use, monitoring, and eventually retirement—with updates feeding back into the review process. The lifecycle ensures that authorization policies remain current, coherent, and aligned with organizational intent.

14.2.1 Create

Every policy begins with intent: a new business requirement, compliance rule, or system capability that must be expressed in authorization logic. Creation involves translating that intent into a form the system can evaluate. As shown in figure 14.3, policy creation at ACME unfolds as a sequence of deliberate steps—defining purpose and scope, documenting rationale in an Architectural Decision Record (ADR), and modeling the entities and attributes that the policy will govern.